

Psychological Pathways to Academic Success: Evidences from Tribal and Non-Tribal Adolescent Students in Kashmir

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ABSTRACT

The paper represents a thorough investigation into the personality, social intelligence, self-esteem, and academic achievements of tribal and non-tribal adolescent students in the Kashmir region. The primary objectives of the study were to examine the personality traits of tribal and non-tribal adolescent students in the Kashmir region. The paper is a complete review of the title mentioned.

KEYWORDS: *Tribe, Personality, Trait, Social Intelligence, Self-Esteem, Academic Performance.*

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INTRODUCTION:

Diversity, broadly defined, encompasses the differences among groups and individuals in terms of acceptance, respect, and approval, typically based on demographic and philosophical distinctions. This concept of diversity extends to areas such as gender, ethnicity, socio-economic status, sexual orientation, race, ideologies, age, physical abilities, political, and religious views. Essentially, diversity refers to the extent of differences that help identify characteristics within individuals and groups, where these characteristics are generally similar among well-defined groups or individuals. India is a prime example of diversity, being a nation of various religions, cultures, and communities. As one of the oldest civilizations in history, dating back over 50 centuries, India showcases a wide range of landscapes, peoples, cultures, languages, ethnicities, and traditions that are unmatched elsewhere in the world. Despite its vast diversity, the country thrives on the motto of "unity in diversity." This unity has enabled Indian culture to withstand the test of time,

leading to the development of a composite Indian culture characterized by stable patterns of pluralism. India's diversity is built on the premise of integration, uniting various cultures, religions, and practices. Despite being a complex fusion of cultural, social, linguistic, and religious identities, India is among the richest zones of diversity in the world, having forged a strong unified identity known as "Indian." The factors contributing to India's diversity are multifaceted. India's physical geography is also diverse, with the towering Himalayas in the north, the vast Thar Desert in the west, and the southern peninsula tapering into the Bay of Bengal, the Indian Ocean, and the Arabian Sea. The origins of Indian culture are difficult to pinpoint precisely, but it is widely agreed that it emerged from ancient hunting and gathering cultures thousands of years ago. Foreign invasions and the birth of multiple religions on Indian soil have further shaped India's vast and distinct society. The country's vitality lies in its ability to tolerate different migrations, views, invasions, customs, and

understandings. Education is a key factor in upward mobility, but there is a significant gap between marginalized and general populations, with scheduled tribes and scheduled castes facing alarming dropout rates. India has the largest population of scheduled tribes in the world.

The term 'tribe' refers to a group of people who share a common ancestor, culture, territory, and descent, and who live under the leadership of a common chief. Essentially, the term 'tribe' is a modern label for communities that are descended from the ancient inhabitants of a specific region. The concept of a 'tribe' was introduced during the colonial era. Tribes can also be categorized based on their means of livelihood, including hunters, food gatherers, fishermen, peasants, shifting cultivators, and plantation and industrial workers. According to the 2011 Census, the tribal population makes up approximately 8.2% of India's total population. The major tribes in India include the Santhals, Gonds, Minas, Mundas, Bhils, Bodos, and Oraons.

Scheduled Tribes of Jammu and Kashmir: Jammu & Kashmir, a union territory of India, is renowned globally for its breathtaking natural beauty. Often referred to as the "paradise on earth," it is surrounded by the majestic Himalayas and stunning waterfalls. The region is divided into two administrative areas: Jammu and Kashmir. The Kashmir Valley is known for its stunning mountainous landscapes, while Jammu draws tourists with its revered Hindu temples. Jammu and Kashmir is home to various scheduled tribes, who are dispersed throughout the region's mountainous terrain. There are 12 constitutionally recognized tribes in Jammu and Kashmir: Balti, Beda, Bot, Brokpa, Changpa, Gaddi, Garra, Mon, Purigpa, Sippi, Gujjars, and Bakerwals. According to the 2011 Census, the total population of scheduled tribes in Jammu and Kashmir is approximately 1.493 million. Among these, the Gujjars have the highest population, totaling 981,000, followed by the Bakerwals with 113,000. The majority of these Gujjars (974,000) and Bakerwals (112,000) are from the Muslim community, while Hindu Gujjars and Bakerwals number around 4,400 and 1,400, respectively.

Constitutional Safeguards for Tribal Population:

Before India gained independence, there were few substantial or intentional efforts made to improve the conditions of scheduled tribes. However, during the British rule, some notable measures were introduced for the development of scheduled tribes.

Personality: The concept of "personality" has been a foundational element in both pure and applied psychology. Its study began as early as 400 B.C. with

Hippocrates and was later expanded upon by various typologists, including Kretschmer, Sheldon, Jung, Spranger, Friedman & Rosenman, Berman, James, and Binet. In contrast to the type theories, the trait approach to personality was advanced by theorists such as Allport and Cattell. Eysenck later developed a model that integrated aspects of both type and trait approaches. Another significant development in the study of personality came from psychoanalysts like Freud, Adler, Jung, Horney, and Erickson.

Literature Review

Human knowledge is accumulated from various sources such as books, encyclopaedias, archives, and libraries. Unlike other species, which begin each generation with a blank slate, humans build upon the accumulated knowledge of previous generations. This cumulative process underscores the importance of identifying unresolved questions and specific issues that require further investigation in the review of existing literature. A literature review is a crucial step in any research study.

Rashid and Singh (2020) investigated the Self-Esteem levels of Tribal and Non-Tribal Adolescent students in the Kashmir valley. The sample comprised 180 adolescent students, with 90 from tribal backgrounds and 90 from non-tribal backgrounds, selected randomly from various higher secondary institutions.

Mir (2019) explored and compared the School Climate, Emotional Intelligence, Learning Styles, and Academic Achievement of secondary school students. The study included a sample of 600 students (300 male and 300 female) randomly chosen from ten districts in the Kashmir valley. Various measurement tools were used, including the School Climate Scale by Sajad and Sayeed (2019), the Emotional Intelligence Scale by Kumar and Narain (2014), and others for assessing academic achievement.

Sharma (2019) conducted a comparative study on Self-Esteem, Academic Achievement, and Psychological Well-Being between male and female Adolescent students. The sample consisted of 317 students (155 male and 162 female) from various secondary schools. Using multiple regression, mean, and t-test analyses, the study found significant differences in Self-Esteem between genders. Male students showed higher general Self-Esteem, while female students had higher social Self-Esteem.

Lone and Khan (2018) examined Social Intelligence among Tribal and Non-Tribal students in the Kashmir valley. The study sampled 600 students from all ten districts and utilized the Chadda and Ganesan Social Intelligence Scale (2009) for data collection.

Statistical analyses including means and t-tests revealed that Non-Tribal students outperformed Tribal students in various dimensions of Social Intelligence, such as Patience, Confidence, Cooperativeness, Sensitivity, Social Environment Regulation, Tactfulness, and Sense of Humor.

Mir (2018) explored and compared the Academic Achievement of rural and urban secondary school students. The sample included 260 students from four secondary schools, and data was collected using an information schedule. The findings showed a significant difference in Academic Achievement between rural and urban students, with urban students achieving higher grades compared to their rural counterparts.

Ninama (2018) investigated Need Achievement, Adjustment, and Personality traits among Tribal and Non-Tribal students. The sample of 600 students was randomly selected, and various tools including the Achievement Motivation Inventory by Jansari (2012) and the Introvert-Extrovert Personality Inventory by Jansari (2015) were employed.

Pingle, G.G. (2017) investigated the relationship between personality traits and academic performance among higher secondary school students. The study involved a randomly selected sample of 850 students from class 12. To gather relevant data, the study used the Multi-Dimensional Assessment of Personality Series Form, developed by M/S Psy.com Associations, New Delhi in 1996, and Ahuja's Group Intelligence Test.

Andrabi, A.A. (2015) compared various factors between tribal and non-tribal adolescents, including socio-economic status, scientific temper, academic achievement, and emotional intelligence. The study involved a sample of 564 adolescents from two districts in Kashmir—Anantnag and Kupwara—who were selected through a stratified random sampling technique from 12 secondary schools.

Methodology

In the preceding chapters, we have thoroughly explored the theoretical framework underpinning the

study, along with the specific objectives and hypotheses that guide it. This discussion was followed by a detailed review of related literature, setting the stage for an in-depth examination of the research methodology and procedural approach used in this study. This chapter is dedicated to elucidating the research methodology and procedures employed to conduct the current study. It covers crucial aspects such as sampling techniques, data collection tools, and statistical treatments. The research methodology and procedural framework serve as a strategic blueprint, guiding the entire study and ensuring that the results can be generalized inferentially. The accuracy and applicability of these generalizations hinge on the selection and application of an appropriate research methodology. To ensure the robustness of the methodology, consultations were sought from various experts, including educators, education specialists, and statisticians. Their insights were instrumental in determining the most effective methodological approach for the study. For the purpose of this research, a randomized sampling technique was utilized to obtain a representative sample of adolescent students. A survey was conducted to gather the necessary data for the study. Given that this study is descriptive in nature, the data collected focuses on describing the attributes of personality, social intelligence, self-esteem, and academic achievement among tribal and non-tribal adolescent students. The chapter is structured around the following key components of the research design:

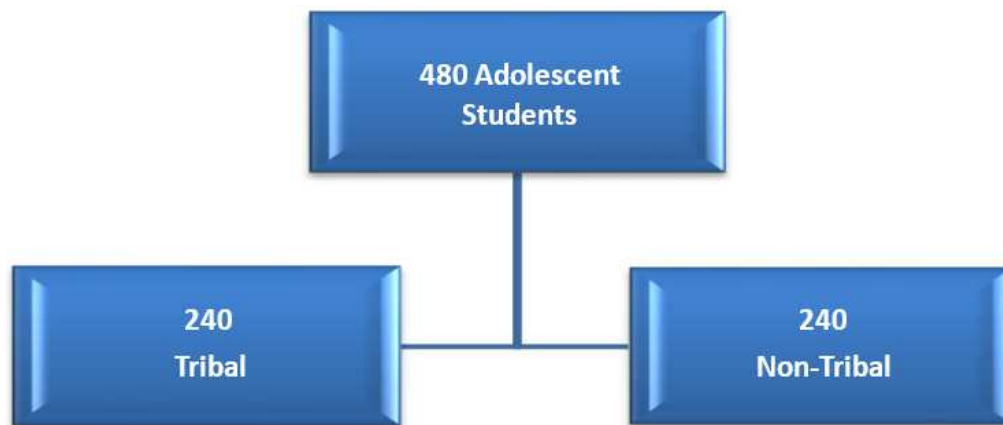
- Population and Sampling
- Data Collection Tools Used
- Procedure of Data Collection
- Statistical Treatment

Population

In research terminology, the population refers to the entire set of individuals or entities from which a sample is drawn. For this study, the population comprises all adolescent students, both tribal and non-tribal, currently enrolled in various high schools, secondary schools, and higher secondary schools across the Kashmir region.

Sample

A sample represents a subset of the population selected for the purpose of the study. Sampling can be carried out using either random or non-random methods. The objective of sampling is to draw conclusions about the larger population based on the characteristics observed in the sample. Since the overall population is not directly observable, the researcher applied the Krejcie-Morgan formula to determine the appropriate sample size. According to this formula, a sample size of approximately 479.61 is needed for a 10% population proportion. In practice, this was rounded to 480 participants. Consequently, a sample comprising 480 adolescent students was selected, with an equal distribution of 240 tribal and 240 non-tribal students. These participants were randomly chosen from three districts within the Kashmir region: Pulwama, Anantnag, and Kupwara. The random sampling method ensures that each individual had an equal probability of being included in the sample, thereby enhancing the representativeness of the study. The breakdown of the sample is as follows:



For the current study, a total of 15 high schools, secondary schools, and higher secondary schools were randomly selected from three districts within the Kashmir region: Pulwama, Anantnag, and Kupwara. To ensure a representative sample, 30% of the adolescent students from each of these selected schools were chosen through random sampling.

Selection of Schools: A randomized selection process was employed to choose 15 schools from the aforementioned districts. This method ensured that the selection was unbiased and that the chosen schools represented a diverse cross-section of the educational landscape in the Kashmir region.

Sampling of Students: Within each of the selected schools, 30% of the adolescent students were randomly selected. This proportion was chosen to balance the need for a sufficiently large sample size with practical considerations of resource allocation and data collection.

District	Name of the school	Total sample taken	
		Tribal students	Non-tribal students
Anantnag	Government High School Dooru	24	06
	GHS.Nowgam Shangas	20	08
	Government High School Dialgam	14	22
	GHS Aishmuqam	16	06
	Delhi Public School Sangam	06	36
Kupwara	Government High School Khumeriyal	20	14
	Government High School Drugmulla	18	10
	Government Boys High School Sogam	20	12
	Government Girls High School Sogam	17	13
	Shaheen Public High School Handwara	06	30
Pulwama	Government Secondary School Satoora	13	13
	Government High School Batnoora	20	14
	Government Secondary School Dadasara	10	20
	Modern Public Secondary School Dadasara	08	24
	Modern Public High School Machama Tral	28	12
Total	240	240	

Table: List of high/secondary school students included in the sample

TOOLS USED: Following tools were being used in order to measure the personality, self- esteem, social intelligence and academic achievement of tribal and non-tribal adolescent students. **High School Personality Questionnaire (Cattell)** **Social Intelligence Scale (Chadda and Ganesan)** **Self Esteem Scale (Rosenberg).**

Conclusion: The study represents a thorough investigation into the personality, social intelligence, self-esteem, and academic achievements of tribal and non-tribal adolescent students in the Kashmir region.

The primary objectives of the study were to: Examine the personality traits of tribal and non-tribal adolescent students in the Kashmir region. Assess the social intelligence of these students. Evaluate their self-esteem levels. Analyze their academic achievements. Compare personality traits between the two groups. Compare social intelligence between the two groups. Compare self-esteem levels between the two groups. Compare academic achievements between the two groups.

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